

Use-Case Flow Specification

Remote Team Time-Tracking & Project Approver | Problem Statement #46

Use Case

UC-ID: UC-05

Name: Approve Timesheet

Primary Actor: Engineering Manager

Secondary Actors: Remote Developer (notified of outcome), Budget/Reporting Service (extension: Flag Budget Overrun)

Preconditions

- The Engineering Manager is authenticated and has an active session with the "Manager" role.
- At least one timesheet submitted by a developer on the manager's team exists with status "Pending Approval" (see UC-02: Submit Timesheet).
- Each time entry in the timesheet has already passed validation (UC-04: Validate Timesheet Entries) and daily-hour limits (FR-001).

Postconditions

- **Success:** The timesheet status is updated to "Approved"; approved hours are added to the project's budget burn calculation (FR-005); the Remote Developer is notified.
- **Failure/Alternate:** The timesheet status is updated to "Rejected" with the manager's comment attached; the Remote Developer is notified and may revise and resubmit.

Main Success Scenario

- 1 Engineering Manager opens the "Pending Approvals" dashboard.
- 2 System displays the list of timesheets with status "Pending Approval" for the manager's direct reports.
- 3 Engineering Manager selects a timesheet to review.
- 4 System displays the timesheet detail: daily hours, linked Jira ticket IDs, and total hours for the period.
- 5 Engineering Manager reviews the entries against the project's Jira board and budget summary (UC-08).
- 6 Engineering Manager selects "Approve."
- 7 System validates that total submitted hours do not exceed 24 hours in any single calendar day (re-check of FR-001).
- 8 System checks the resulting project budget burn rate; if the burn rate would exceed 90% of the allocated budget, the system triggers the "Flag Budget Overrun" extension (UC-07) and displays a warning banner to the manager, who may still proceed.
- 9 System updates the timesheet status to "Approved" and timestamps the approval.
- 10 System recalculates the project's budget burn rate (FR-005) and refreshes all connected dashboards within 500 ms (NFR-001).
- 11 System sends an approval notification to the Remote Developer.
- 12 Use case ends successfully.

Alternate Flow — A1: Timesheet Rejected

- 6a. At step 6, the Engineering Manager selects "Reject" instead of "Approve."
- 6a1. System prompts the manager to enter a rejection comment.
- 6a2. If the comment field is left empty, the system blocks submission and displays a validation error (FR-003); the manager returns to step 6a1.
- 6a3. Once a comment is provided, the system updates the timesheet status to "Rejected" and stores the comment.
- 6a4. System notifies the Remote Developer of the rejection and comment.
- 6a5. The Remote Developer may revise the timesheet and resubmit it (returns to UC-02: Submit Timesheet).
- 6a6. Use case ends (timesheet not approved).